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ORVYS RESEARCH · BIHAR CSR SERIES

CSR Skilling & Education in Bihar

Verified skilling and education CSR initiatives in Bihar: IBM, Pratham, Piramal Foundation, STAIRS and others, with Orvys assessment.

Published November 2026
Data: Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Census 2011, NFHS-5

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THE STRUCTURAL CHALLENGE

Bridging the youth employability deficit

Bihar possesses one of India's youngest populations, with over 38 million individuals under the age of 15. However, foundational learning deficits, low female labour-force participation, and a shortage of modern technical infrastructure create an urgent demand for placement-linked skilling programmes.

While prominent private-sector initiatives like IBM SkillsBuild and IBM STEM for Girls have demonstrated scalable models in government schools and polytechnics, skilling CSR remains heavily skewed toward urban centres, leaving rural Aspirational Districts severely under-served.

VERIFIED PROGRAMMES

Active skilling initiatives in Bihar

CSR PROGRAMME Undated

IBM STEM for Girls

IBM, with the Department of School & Mass Education · Statewide · *Education & skilling*

MoU to introduce IBM STEM for Girls in 30 higher secondary schools across three districts, reaching close to 13,000 students over three years. It covers digital literacy, coding, 21st-century skills and career planning.

> **Orvys Perspective:** Extend it to districts with the lowest CSR per person, track girls' transition into STEM streams, and build teacher capacity so the programme lasts.

Verified sources:

1. India CSR, IBM MoU with Bihar for STEM for Girls

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SKILLING PLATFORM 2019 onward

IBM SkillsBuild (via delivery partners, including CSRBOX)

IBM; CSRBOX as a delivery partner · Statewide · *Education & skilling*

A free digital learning and career-readiness platform, launched in India in 2019 with the Directorate General of Training. CSRBOX reported providing over 100,000 learners access to future skills through SkillsBuild by June 2021 (national figure).

> **Orvys Perspective:** Run Hindi-first, Bihar-specific cohorts through ITIs and polytechnics, connect them to employers, track completion through to placement, and offer low-bandwidth access.

Verified sources:

1. IBM India Newsroom, SkillsBuild collaborations (17 Jun 2021)

PROGRAMME Sep 2025

One Bihar One Goal

STAIRS Foundation · Statewide · *Sports & youth*

Launched on 30 September 2025 from Patna to build a grassroots sports system: youth clubs, high-performance centres in 15 sports, and a statewide football talent hunt.

> **Orvys Perspective:** Publish data on the talent pipeline, build in safeguarding and girls' participation targets, and attract CSR co-funding for district centres.

Verified sources:

1. The CSR Universe, STAIRS Foundation 'One Bihar One Goal' (30 Sep 2025)

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PROGRAMME Mar 2024

Yuva Seva Sadan (Aspirational Bharat Collaborative)
Piramal Foundation · Katihar, Patna · *Youth & community*

Youth volunteering for community development, with MJM Women's College, Katihar and Patna University's Department of Rural Studies.

> **Orvys Perspective:** Link the youth volunteers to district CSR programmes as field monitors and community mobilisers.

Verified sources:

1. Piramal Foundation, youth initiatives in Bihar and Assam (10 Mar 2024)

ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICT GAP

Where skilling investment is needed most

Aspirational districts contain the highest proportion of first-generation learners. Table sorted by lowest per-capita CSR received in FY 2023-24.

District	FY24 CSR	₹/person	State rank
Banka	**₹0.15 Cr**	₹0.7	#34 of 38
Katihar	**₹0.54 Cr**	₹1.8	#29 of 38
Khagaria	**₹0.50 Cr**	₹3.0	#30 of 38
Araria	**₹1.16 Cr**	₹4.1	#26 of 38
Purnia	**₹2.02 Cr**	₹6.2	#22 of 38
Sitamarhi	**₹2.74 Cr**	₹8.0	#19 of 38
Nawada	**₹2.24 Cr**	₹10.1	#21 of 38
Jamui	**₹4.49 Cr**	₹25.5	#13 of 38
Sheikhpura	**₹1.94 Cr**	₹30.6	#23 of 38
Gaya	**₹13.51 Cr**	₹30.8	#5 of 38
Aurangabad	**₹10.63 Cr**	₹41.8	#8 of 38
Begusarai	**₹20.09 Cr**	₹67.6	#3 of 38
Muzaffarpur	**₹52.00 Cr**	₹108.3	#1 of 38

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Verified sources:

1. India CSR, IBM MoU with Bihar for STEM for Girls
2. IBM India Newsroom, SkillsBuild collaborations (17 Jun 2021)
3. J-PAL, community partnerships for scaling learning interventions (Pratham)
4. Piramal Foundation, youth initiatives in Bihar and Assam (10 Mar 2024)
5. The CSR Universe, STAIRS Foundation 'One Bihar One Goal' (30 Sep 2025)
6. National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), 2019-21, Bihar fact sheet